E-mail Marketing is Dead...

...But Here's the Solution

Who is Chris Pirillo?

- Author, Poor Richard's E-mail Publishing
- Founder, Brain Trust Discussion List
- Columnist, Computer Power User
- Owner, Lockergnome.com
- Marketer, Rent My Chest
- Blogger, chris.pirillo.com
- Former Host, TechTV's Call for Help

Why Do We Use E-mail?

- It's easy to use, adapt, and explain
- List software is powerful
- One-to-many communication
- Conversion rates were good
- Inbox is checked on a regular basis
- Demographics

Why Is The Model Changing?

- Filters are killing 25% of legit deliveries
- Reduced trust from users
- Increasingly polluted channel
- More customer support issues
- We're guilty before proven innocent
- Conversion rates are decreasing
- Challenge-response adoption

What Happens Now?

- Blacklists continue to grow
- We pay for whitelisting services
- The fight with ISPs escalates
- Users begin to gather info in other ways
- We publish only to the Web
- Outlook 2003 blocks HTML images
- E-mail becomes cost / brand prohibitive

What Do We Need?

- An easy way to deliver content
- An open, cross-platform standard
- Less-costly services and/or software
- Fewer data delivery nightmares
- A viable alternative to e-mail

What Do Users Want?

- Information privacy
- Subscription control
- Established trust
- Worthwhile content
- Fewer flaming hoops
- Convenient access

RSS



"I believe this is just the beginning of a tectonic shift that your organization must plan for."

Brian Livingston, E-Business Secrets Newsletter Editor / InfoWorld columnist

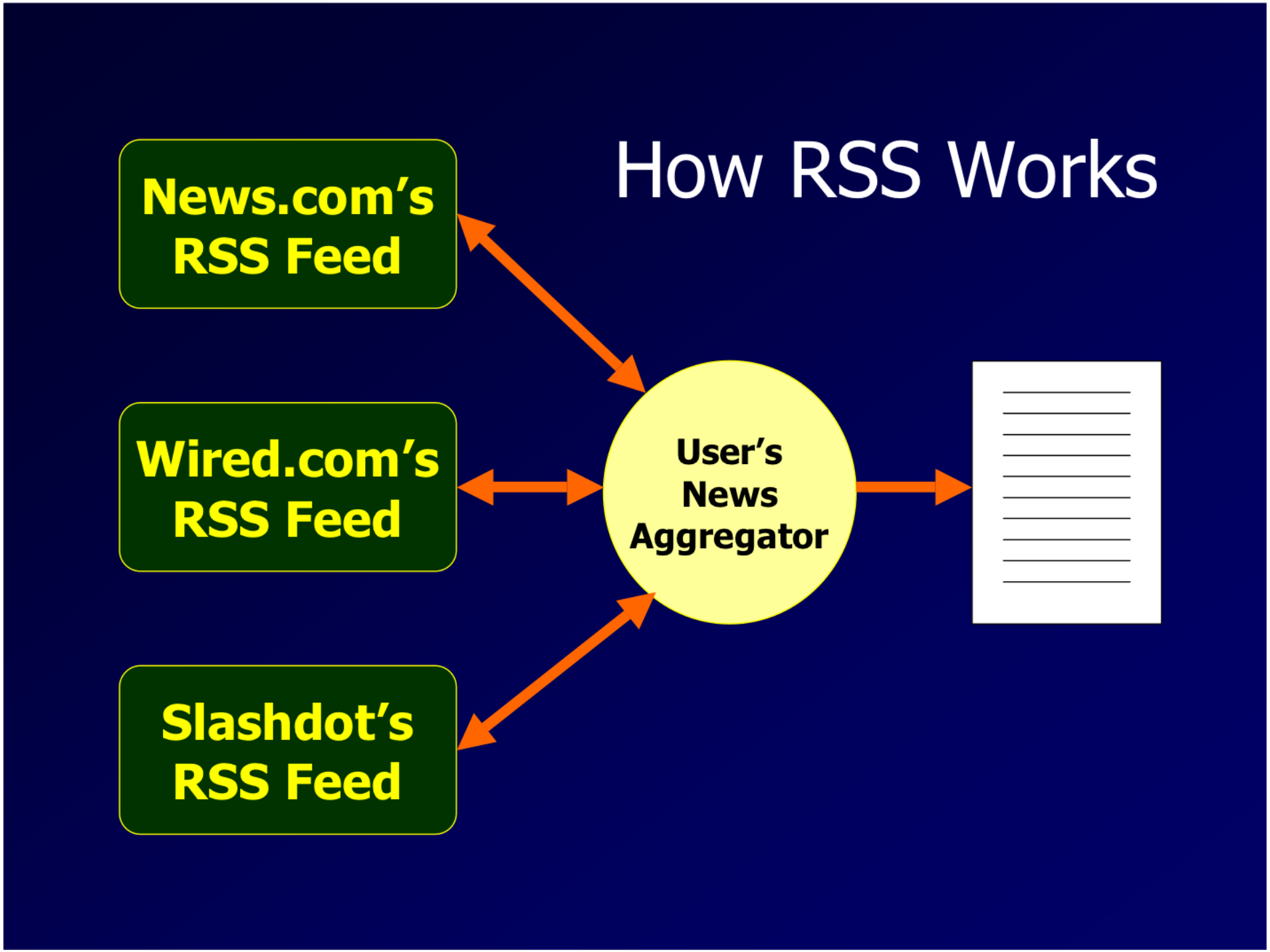
What is RSS?

- Really Simple Syndication
- Rich Site Summary

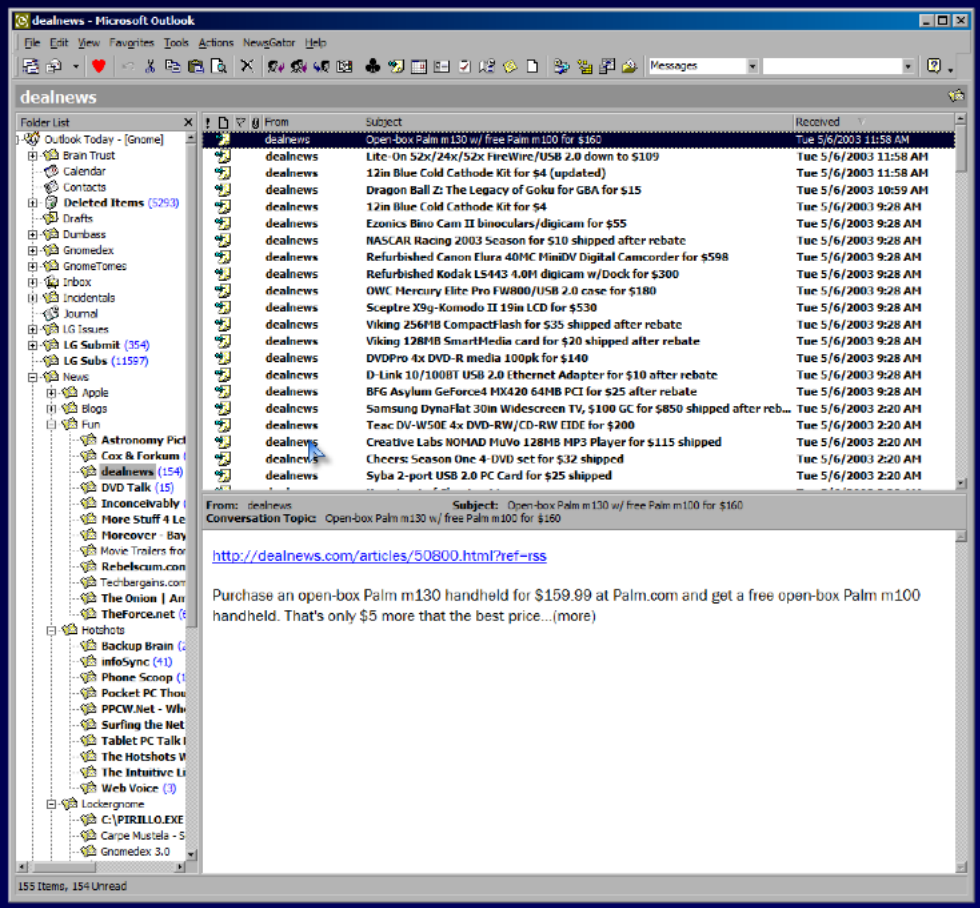
- An XML document / Web page
- A file that contains the latest headlines
- Easily published, easily subscribed to
- A valid content delivery mechanism

What Does RSS Look Like?

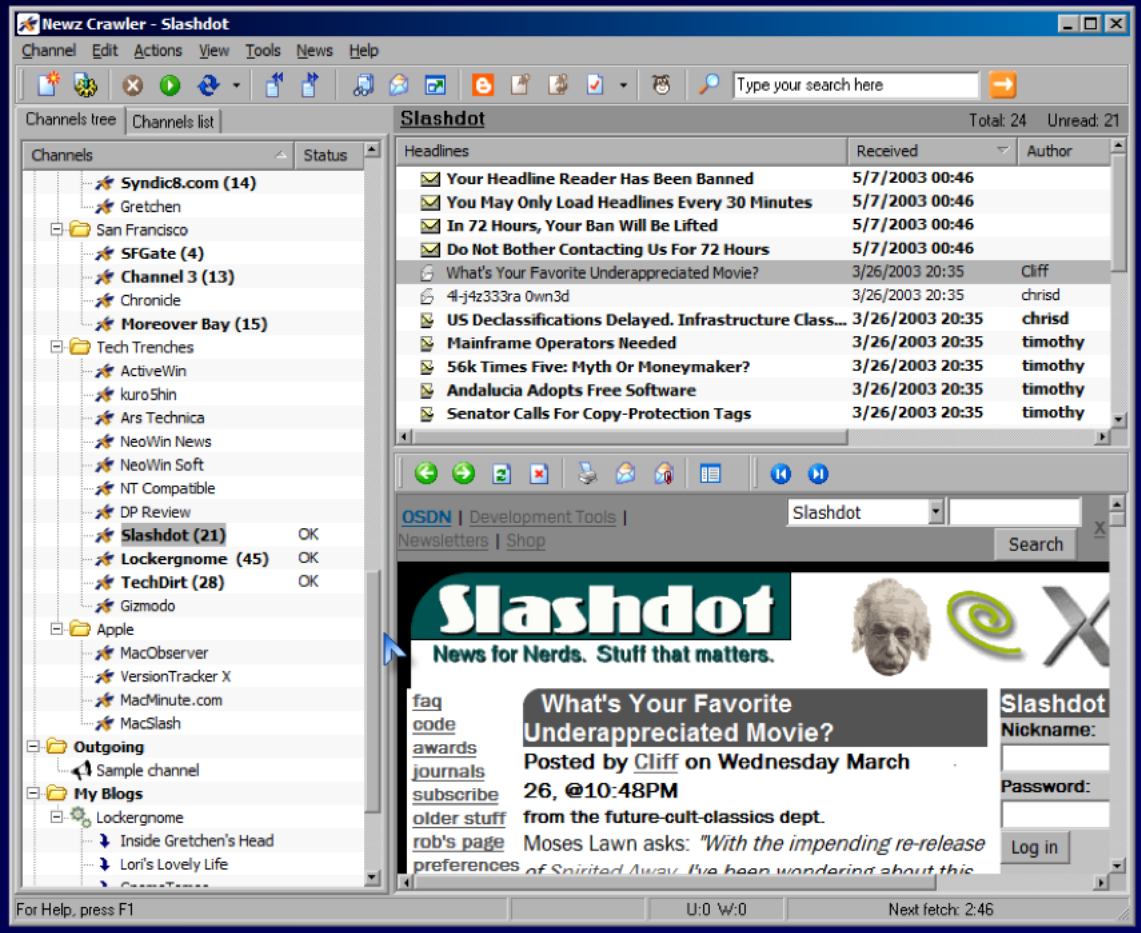
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<item>
<title>Indiana Jones on DVD!</title>
<link>http://dvdtalk.com/</link>
<description>Lucasfilm Ltd. and
Paramount Home Video have officially
announced the DVD release for the
highly anticipated Indiana Jones Trilogy!
</description>
</item>
```


How RSS Works
News.com's RSS Feed
Wired.com's RSS Feed
Slashdot's RSS Feed
User's News Aggregator

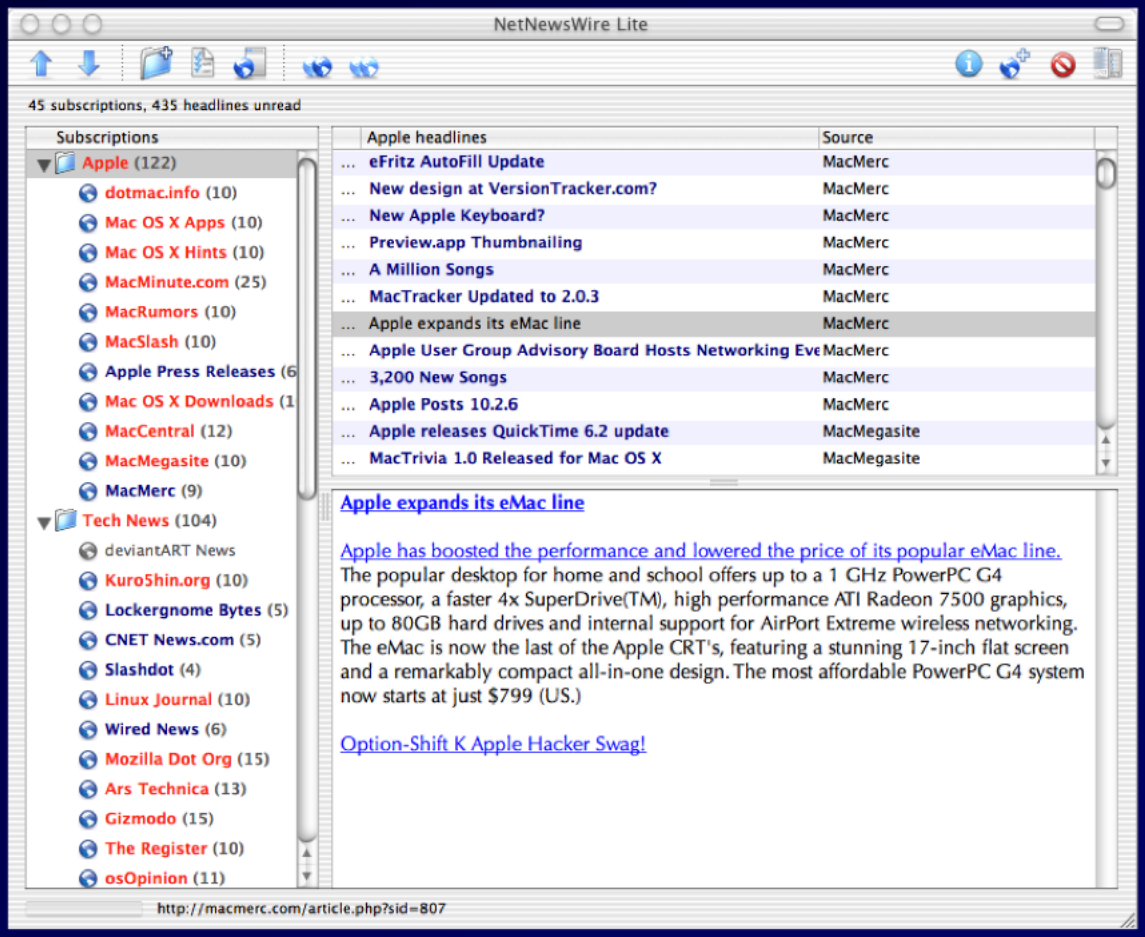
NewsGator for Outlook



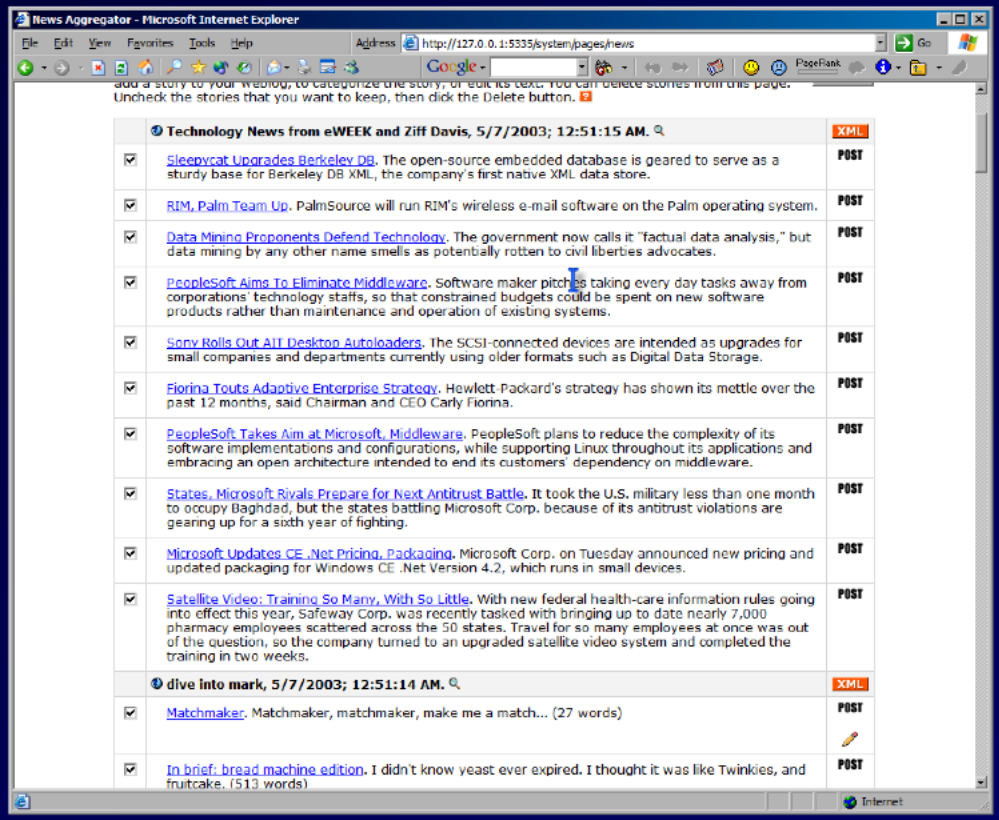
NewzCrawler



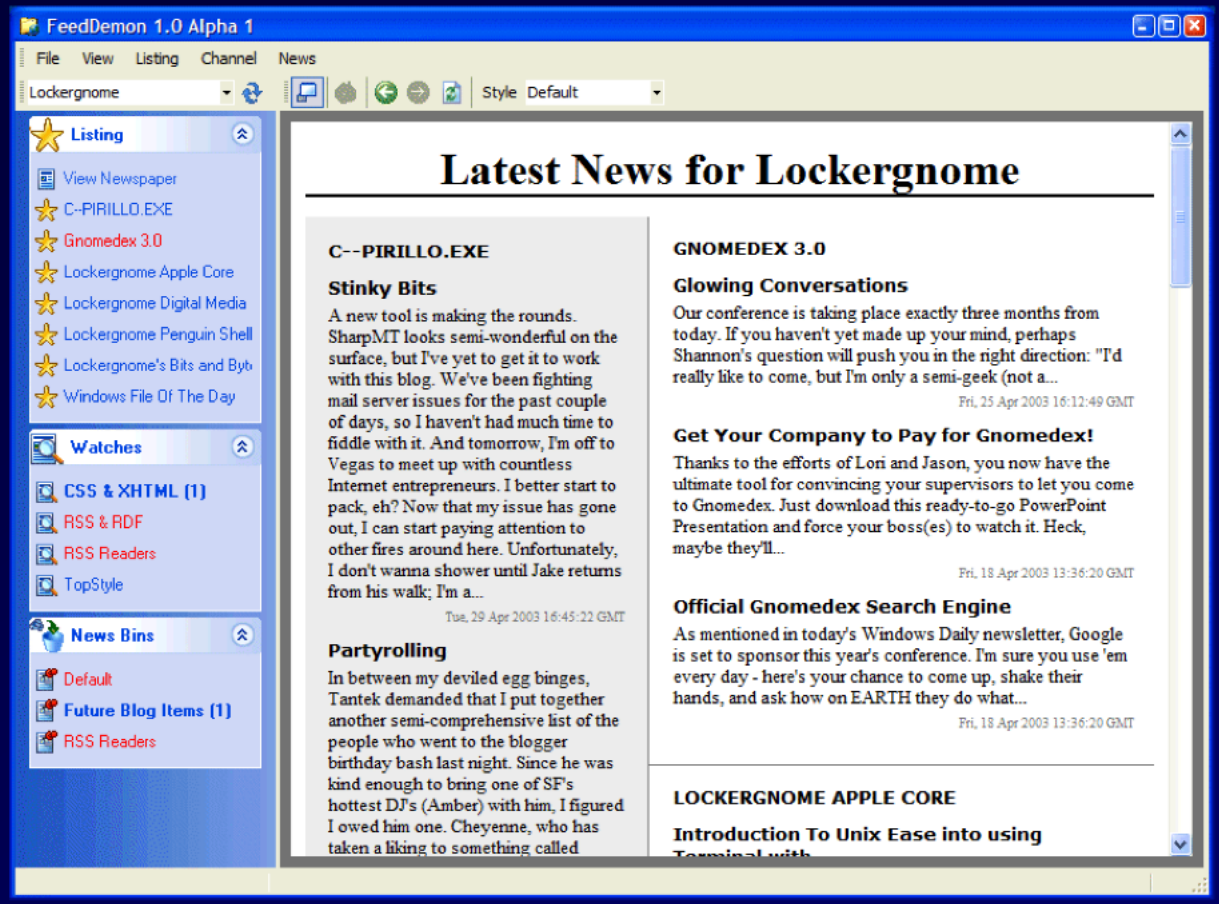
NetNewsWire



Radio UserLand



FeedDemon


FeedDemon 1.0 Alpha 1
File View Listing Channel News
Lockergnome
Style Default
Listing
View Newspaper
C--PIRILLO.EXE
Gnomedex 3.0
Lockergnome Apple Core
Lockergnome Digital Media
Lockergnome Penguin Shell
Lockergnome's Bits and Byt
Windows File Of The Day
Watches
CSS & XHTML (1)
RSS & RDF
RSS Readers
TopStyle
News Bins
Default
Future Blog Items (1)
RSS Readers
Latest News for Lockergnome
C--PIRILLO.EXE
Stinky Bits
A new tool is making the rounds. SharpMT looks semi-wonderful on the surface, but I've yet to get it to work with this blog. We've been fighting mail server issues for the past couple of days, so I haven't had much time to fiddle with it. And tomorrow, I'm off to Vegas to meet up with countless Internet entrepreneurs. I better start to pack, eh? Now that my issue has gone out, I can start paying attention to other fires around here. Unfortunately, I don't wanna shower until Jake returns from his walk; I'm a...
Tue, 29 Apr 2003 16:45:22 GMT
Partyrolling
In between my deviled egg binges, Tantek demanded that I put together another semi-comprehensive list of the people who went to the blogger birthday bash last night. Since he was kind enough to bring one of SF's hottest DJ's (Amber) with him, I figured I owed him one. Cheyenne, who has taken a liking to something called
GNOMEDEX 3.0
Glowing Conversations
Our conference is taking place exactly three months from today. If you haven't yet made up your mind, perhaps Shannon's question will push you in the right direction: "I'd really like to come, but I'm only a semi-geek (not a...
Fri, 25 Apr 2003 16:12:49 GMT
Get Your Company to Pay for Gnomedex!
Thanks to the efforts of Lori and Jason, you now have the ultimate tool for convincing your supervisors to let you come to Gnomedex. Just download this ready-to-go PowerPoint Presentation and force your boss(es) to watch it. Heck, maybe they'll...
Fri, 18 Apr 2003 13:36:20 GMT
Official Gnomedex Search Engine
As mentioned in today's Windows Daily newsletter, Google is set to sponsor this year's conference. I'm sure you use 'em every day - here's your chance to come up, shake their hands, and ask how on EARTH they do what...
Fri, 18 Apr 2003 13:36:20 GMT
LOCKERGNOME APPLE CORE
Introduction To Unix Ease into using

"Any publisher and any marketer who isn't grabbing onto RSS with both hands and both feet is being willfully negligent."

Jonathan Angel, Senior Editor for Adweek Magazine's' Technology Marketing

Where Did It Come From?

- UserLand created the spec
- Netscape used it for its portal
- Gained popularity with Slashdot's feed
- Blogging software auto-generated it
- News aggregators started to pop up
- People started to see its power

Why Use It Today?

- It's "push" without the "proprietary"
- Today, it complements e-mail
- Tomorrow, it replaces news delivery
- RSS works on all platforms
- It's not just for bloggers!

"I wrongly assumed it was a super-techie thing I could never use. Finally, I'm figuring out how amazing RSS is and I'm totally addicted!"

Shira Silberman, Waggener Edstrom Account Executive

E-mail

- Set up list software
- Provide form
- Promote list
- Capture address
- Confirm address
- Create newsletter
- Send newsletter

RSS

- Set up RSS feed
- Provide link
- Promote feed
- Post content

E-mail

- High Impact
- Cost-effective
- Immediate
- Measurable
- Targeted

RSS

- High Impact
- Cost-effective
- Immediate
- Measurable
- Targeted

The Biggest Differences?

- RSS blacklists don't exist
- RSS is an "unspammable" medium
- RSS subscriptions imply confirmation
- RSS subscriptions are self-purging
- RSS has fewer negative perceptions

The Benefits of RSS

- No e-mail address required
- User controls subscription
- Publisher controls content
- Can be password protected
- Thousands of existing channels
- Growing popularity
- It’s just another data output format

Can It Be Monetized?

- Advertisements can be placed within
- Premium feeds can be sold
- Traffic can still be measured
- Web-based RSS services
- News aggregator software creation
- Value-add for consulting clients
- Deliver headlines and push to Web site

"In the end, RSS and news aggregators look to represent a new end-user 'target' platform - like the Web browser and e-mail client - that b-to-b marketers cannot afford to ignore."

Richard Karpinski, BToBOnline.com

How Does One Create RSS?

- It's so simple, you can do it by hand
- With blogging software
- Use a free Web-based generator
- Download a script to help you
- Hire a programmer to create a tool
- Further info in our training manual

How Does One Market RSS?

- Next to e-mail subscription form
- Advertise it on other sites / feeds
- Use orange XML button in key places
- Educate customers on its power
- Show friends and business partners
- Submit it to RSS indexes / engines
- Further info in our training manual

The Drawbacks of RSS

- News aggregators still maturing
- Coming out of early adopter stages
- No true control over presentation
- “New” publishing model

The Future of RSS

- Further desktop aggregation integration
- Mass consumer adoption
- Better tools to create / read
- Ultimately replacing other push models

RSS-Related Web Sites

- Technorati.com – RSS Link Cosmos
- Feedster.com – The Google of RSS
- Syndic8.com – RSS Listing Service
- NewsIsFree.com – RSS Portal
- Backend.UserLand.com – Validator
- News.Google.com – Driven on RSS

Ben Hammersley's Book



Tech Glossary

- HTML: Hypertext Markup Language
- XML: Extensible Markup Language
- OPML: Outline Processor Markup Language
- PHP: Hypertext Preprocessor
- RDF: Rich Document Format

This presenation has ended.
Click anywhere to return.

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